Leadership Studies Department

COURSE SYLLABUS

Course Information

DSRT734 - M51 Infer Stats in Decision-Making
Fall 2025 Full Term
Course Format: Hybrid
CRN: 2025-FALL-MAIN-DSRT-734-M51
Class Time and Location: Dallas Campus | Friday/Saturday/Sunday | 8:00 AM - 10:00 PM | 11/07/2025 - 11/09/202

Instructor Information

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Phone: 855.791.7199
Office Location: Online
Office Hours/Preferred Contact Times: Weekly Online Office Hours or by appointment

Course Description

DSRT 734 – Inferential Statistics in Decision-making (3 hours) This course focuses on the descriptive and inferential statistics commonly used in organizational administration. Course activities include the application of statistical methods to research design, as well as an investigation of how these methods can contribute to school improvement. Specific concepts include measures of central tendency and variability, probability theory, estimation and significance, and correlation and regression.

Course Objectives

Upon completion of this course:

- Students will describe the essential characteristics of quantitative research.
- Students will apply inferential statistical tests on problems requiring parametric and non-parametric analyses.
- Students will identify potential research designs for various problems.
- Students will analyze statistical information in the professional literature on a topic related to their own research project.

Learner Outcomes

Departmental Objectives Include:

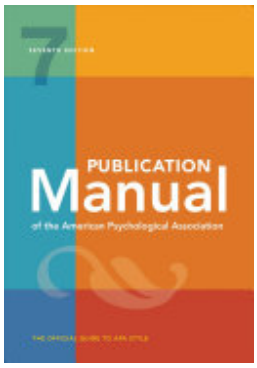
- Students will apply statistical tests to answer research questions.
- 1A: Students will critically assess and plan to solve an educational problem.
- Students will analyze statistical results.
- 1B: Students will demonstrate significant improvement in critical thinking, analysis, and leadership concepts that facilitate institutional improvement.
- 2A: Students will demonstrate understanding of the qualities and attributes of effective leadership.
- 2B: Students will demonstrate an understanding of leading members of diverse communities.
- 2C: Students will demonstrate a familiarity with the major theories and scholarship in the discipline of Leadership.
- 3A: Students will apply analysis to improve professional writing skills.
- 3B: Students will analyze research and demonstrate professional communication skills.
- 3C: Students will produce a literature review in support of an approved dissertation.

- 3D: Students will write effectively on the various components of the dissertation.
- 3E: Students will broaden their foundational understanding of professional history, statistical analysis, leadership theory, and knowledge.
- 4A: Students will compare and contrast major theories, positions, or topics in their respective specialty areas.
- 5A: Graduates will confidently participate in ethical leadership roles in professional and/or community settings.

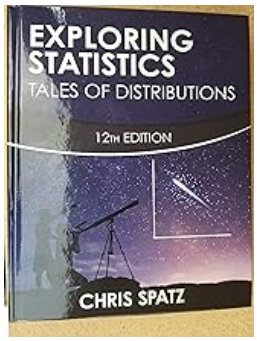
Course Website

Access to the course website is required via the iLearn portal on the University of the Cumberlands website: http://www.ucumberlands.edu/ilearn/ or https://ucumberlands.blackboard.com/

Required Books and Resources



Title: Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association
ISBN: 9781433832178
Authors: American Psychological Association
Publisher: American Psychological Association (APA)
Publication Date: 2019-10-01



Title: Exploring Statistics
ISBN: 9780996339223
Authors: Chris Spatz
Publication Date: 2019-01-01

To access your course materials, simply click on the Course Materials link located on the content page of your course in iLearn.

Requirements and Policies

Academic Dishonesty Policy

As a Christian liberal arts university committed to the pursuit of truth and understanding, any act of academic dishonesty is especially distressing and cannot be tolerated. In general, academic dishonesty involves the abuse and misuse of information or people to gain an undeserved academic advantage or evaluation.

The common forms of academic dishonesty include:

1. cheating – using deception in the taking of tests or the preparation of written work, using unauthorized materials, copying another person's work with or without consent, or assisting another in such activities;
2. lying – falsifying, fabricating, or forging information in either written or spoken presentations;
3. plagiarism – using the published writings, data, interpretations, or ideas of another without proper documentation.
4. multiple submissions - submitting the same academic written or oral work for which credit was previously received, without the approval of the instructor.

Episodes of academic dishonesty are reported as appropriate to the Vice President for Academic Affairs. The potential penalty for academic dishonesty includes 1) a failing grade on a particular assignment, 2) a failing grade for the entire course, 3) suspension or expulsion, or (4) revocation of a degree.

Executive Residency Attendance Policy

Attendance to each Executive Residency class session is mandatory. Students may make-up no more than one (1) residency session throughout the duration of their academic program. Missing a second residency will result in the student being dismissed from the University.

Each student must be in attendance for the entire duration of the required residency weekend. Late arrivals and/or early departures are not permitted. Punctuality is important as each student is required to have the documented in-seat time per course requirements.

A missed session will result in the student attending a make-up session, and paying a $300 Residency Make-Up fee. In addition, the student may be asked for documentation from the program department providing an explanation as to why the schedule residency session was missed. Make-Up sessions must be completed prior to the end of the term. Noncompliance with this policy will result in dismissal from the executive program.

Participation Policy

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Study after study has linked successful academic performance with good class participation. Those who assume positions of responsibility must “show up” in order to be effective. Therefore, students are expected to actively participate in an intelligent discussion of assigned topics in all areas to help process course material and/or to demonstrate an understanding of course content. Point adjustments will be taken for non-participation.

Course Evaluations

The course evaluation will be open during the last two weeks of the term. To access the evaluation (during that time), visit https://uofcumberlands.campuslabs.com/eval-home/ and log-in using your UC credentials. A reminder email notification will be sent when the evaluation is available.

We value your feedback. Every evaluation is confidential and anonymous. The anonymous results of the course evaluations are not available for faculty to see until after final grades are submitted. Your thoughtful responses guide future improvements for the course and programs.

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Study after study has linked successful academic performance with good class participation. Those who assume positions of responsibility must “show up” in order to be effective. Therefore, students are expected to actively participate in an intelligent discussion of assigned topics in all areas (Discussion Board Activities, Synchronous Sessions, Forums, Shared Papers, etc.) to help process course material and/or to demonstrate an understanding of course content.

Academic Appeal

Both undergraduate and graduate students have the right to challenge a grade. Before filing a formal appeal, the student must discuss the grade with the course instructor and department chair. If discussions with the course instructor and department chair do not lead to a satisfactory conclusion, students may file a formal written appeal with the Vice President for Academic Affairs, who will forward the appeal to the chair of the Academic Appeals Committee.

This formal written appeal to challenge a grade must be filed four weeks after the last day of class for the semester in which the course being appealed occurred. The Academic Appeals Committee then reviews the student's written appeal and gathers information from the instructor and any other relevant parties. The Committee will deliver its recommendation on the complaint to the Vice President for Academic Affairs. After reviewing this recommendation and concurring or amending it, the Vice President for Academic Affairs will inform the student and instructor of the disposition of the complaint no later than the last day of classes of the term in which the complaint was filed.

Records of all actions regarding academic grade appeals, including their final disposition, are maintained by the Vice President for Academic Affairs and the Academic Appeals Committee.

Disability Accommodations

University of the Cumberlands accepts students with certified disabilities and provides reasonable accommodations for their certified needs in the classroom, in housing, in food service or in other areas. For accommodations to be awarded, a student must submit a completed Accommodations Application form and provide documentation of the disability to the Disability Services Coordinator (Shirley Stephens, Gatliff Administration Building, Room 114, accommodations@ucumberlands.edu). When appropriate documentation is on file, approved accommodations will be shared with the student. Each term, students with current academic accommodations will be sent an email to share with their instructors. Accommodations are generally not retroactive. For temporary accommodations such as illness or other approved absences, please use the Temporary Accommodations form. Certifications for other accommodations are normally reviewed annually.

Student Responsibilities

Students should:

- Use University of the Cumberlands email system for all academic, administrative, and co-curricular communication between faculty, staff and peers.
- Check for email and class announcements using iLearn (primary) and University of the Cumberlands webmail (secondary) daily.
- Demonstrate Cumberlands Character in and outside the classroom per the University Mission & Vision
- Ensure you have consistent required technology for the course
- Participate in courses regularly to:
    - Find announcements and updates

    - Complete assignments on time. Keep in mind that all deadlines use Eastern Standard Time (EST).
    - Engage in discussion
    - Connect with fellow students and faculty
- Present written work in an academic and professional manner.
- Take examinations on the designated dates and times. Students should make arrangements with faculty before the designated date for any needed accommodations.
- Contact faculty or student success coordinator with questions or concerns.

Course Policies

- The only authorized electronic means of academic, administrative, and co-curricular communication between University of the Cumberlands and its students is through the UCumberlands email system (i.e. Webmail). Each student is responsible for monitoring his/her University email account frequently. This is the primary email account used to correspond with you directly by the University; imperative program information is sent to this email account specifically from campus and program office.
- Students should check for e-mail and class announcements using iLearn (primary) and University of the Cumberlands webmail (secondary).
- Students are expected to find out class assignments for missed classes and make up missed work.
- Students are expected to find out if any changes have been made in the class or assignment schedule.
- All assignments, unless otherwise instructed, should be submitted in APA format.
- Written work must be presented in a professional manner. Work that is not submitted in a professional manner will not be evaluated and will be returned as unacceptable.
- There is a craft to writing. Spelling, grammar, punctuation, and diction (word usage) are all tools of that craft. Writing at the collegiate level will show careful attention to these elements of craft. Work that does not exhibit care with regard to these elements will be considered as inadequate for college writing and graded accordingly.
- Students are expected to take the examinations on the designated dates. If you are unable to take the exam on the scheduled date and know in advance, you are to make arrangements with your professor before the designated date. If you miss the exam, you must have a legitimate reason as determined by your professor.

Recognizing that a large part of professional life is meeting deadlines, it is necessary to develop time management and organizational skills. Failure to meet the course deadlines may result in penalties. Keep in mind that all deadlines are set using Eastern Standard Time (EST). **Late assignments will NOT be accepted.**

Students are expected to:

• Review any assigned reading material and prepare responses to homework assigned.

• Actively participate in activities, assignments, and discussions.

• Evaluate and react to each other's work in a supportive, constructive manner.

• Complete specific assignments and exams when specified and in a professional manner.

• Utilize learned technologies for class assignments.

• Connect content knowledge from core courses to practical training placement and activities.

Links to Support
UC Academic Catalog: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/academics/academic-catalog
UC Student Handbook: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/student-handbook
Academic Resources & Writing Center: www.ucumberlands.edu/learningcommons
Library: http://www.ucumberlands.edu/library/
Bookstore: https://cumber.bncollege.com/shop/cumberlands/home
About University of the Cumberlands: https://www.ucumberlands.edu/about/presidents-welcome
Instructions for Accessing, Downloading, and Activating Office 365 Pro Plus (free for UC Students):
https://helpdesk.ucumberlands.edu/support/solutions/articles/7000045435

Student Course Concern Early Detection Form

Students can use the Early Detection form to share concerns about their courses with program administration and Academic Affairs. Concerns will be reviewed, and your name will not be shared with the professor unless you grant permission first. The form is not a course evaluation but a place to communicate concerns related to delayed grading beyond 7 days of the assignment's due date, faculty not responding to emails (no response in over 36 hours), or folders or content unavailable.

If you are uncomfortable completing the form, please contact your student success coordinator or academicaffairs@ucumberlands.edu.

Use this Early Detection Form to submit your concerns.

Course Evaluation

Graded work will receive a numeric score reflecting the quality of performance. Relative weights assigned to graded work are as follows: (Include information here if weighted assignments are used)

Students will be evaluated on:

1. Assignments, discussions, and quizzes
2. Practical Connection Assignment - Written Assignment where students will reflect on course concepts and their practical connection to a working environment.

Assignment	Points
Syllabus Quiz	10
Week 4 Quiz	40
Week 6 Quiz	50
Week 10 Quiz	30
Week 12 Quiz	30
Week 14 Quiz	40
Final Comprehensive Exam	200
Journal Article Review	300
Residency Quiz	50
Residency Practical Connection Assignment 11/7/2025	50
Mid-Term Exam	200
Total Points Possible	1000

Grading Scale

A: 90% - 100%
B: 80% - 99%
C: 70% - 79%
F: 69% or Below

Course Schedule

Dates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)	Due Dates*
Weeks 1&2 **8/25/25 - 9/7/25**	Introduction and Descriptive Statistics	Week 1 Syllabus Quiz (20) *Must be completed in Week 1 to avoid being dropped from the class	Sunday 8/31/25
Weeks 3&4 **9/8/25 - 9/21/25**	Correlation and Regression Tests	Week 4 Quiz (60)	Sunday 9/21/25
Weeks 5&6 **9/22/25 - 10/5/25**	*t*-tests Residency (10/3/25-10/5/25)	Week 6 Quiz (50)	Sunday 10/5/25

Dates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)	Due Dates*
Weeks 7&8 **10/6/25 - 10/19/25**	Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)		Sunday 10/19/25
Weeks 9&10 **10/20/25 - 11/2/25**	Chi Square	Residency Assignments Week 10 Quiz (50) Practical Connection(50) Journal Article Review (300) Mid-term (200)	Sunday 11/2/25 Residency Assignments Due 11/7/2025
Weeks 11&12 **11/3/25 - 11/16/25**	Spearman's z test	Week 12 Quiz (30)	Sunday 11/16/25
Weeks 13&14 **11/17/25 - 11/30/25**	Final Exam Review and Writing Research Questions	Week 14 Quiz (40)	Sunday 11/30/25

Dates	Topics/Readings	Assignments and (Point Values)	Due Dates*
Weeks 15&16 **12/1/25 - 12/11/25**	Application of Statistics and Final Exam	Final Comprehensive Exam (200)	Thursday 12/11/25

Syllabus Disclaimer

This syllabus contains important information critical to your success in this course. It includes guidelines for this course and the instructor's current expectations about content, schedule, and requirements necessary for each student to achieve the best educational results. While you must review and become familiar with the contents of this syllabus, the instructor reserves the right to make adjustments or change in the syllabus from time to time. Any changes to the syllabus will be discussed with the students.